

Shopify FP&A; & Financial Performance Analytics

Project Process Guide — how to run it, understand it, and explain it in an interview

1. Business question

The project simulates an FP&A; analyst supporting management. The goal is not to predict the stock price. The goal is to understand operating performance, identify drivers of change, and turn financial results into planning decisions.

2. Data architecture

The project uses three layers: raw public-company facts, a cleaned FP&A; table, and an analysis/scenario layer. The live script pulls SEC XBRL company facts for financial statements and daily market data for optional context.

3. Refreshable design

Run `fetch_data.py` whenever you want a refresh. Financial statement values change when the company files new quarterly/annual results; daily market data can change each trading day. The project deliberately does not pretend that quarterly filings are monthly actuals.

4. Core KPIs

Revenue, gross profit, gross margin, operating expenses, operating expenses as a percentage of revenue, operating income, and operating margin. For Shopify, GMV and MRR are also tracked because management uses them as operating indicators.

5. Variance thinking

Compare current results with the prior comparable period. Ask: Did revenue grow? Did gross profit grow at the same rate? Did expenses grow faster or slower than revenue? Did operating margin expand? This is the bridge from reporting to FP&A.;

6. Forecasting

The model uses management's published Q3 2026 guidance as the anchor and creates conservative/base/upside scenarios. The scenario is not presented as a certainty; it is a decision tool that shows sensitivity to revenue growth, gross-profit growth, and cost discipline.

7. Power BI

Power BI is the presentation layer. The recommended dashboard has an executive page, a forecast/scenario page, and an optional market-context page. The dashboard should make the answer visible in seconds.

8. What you should say in an interview

Explain that you started with the business question, identified the KPIs that connect growth to profitability, automated data collection, standardized the data, calculated margins and growth rates, then translated management guidance into scenarios. That sequence sounds like analyst work rather than a dashboard exercise.

Current analytical snapshot

Metric	Q2 2025	Q2 2026	Change
--------	---------	---------	--------

Revenue (US\$M)	2,680	3,583	33.7%
Gross Profit (US\$M)	1,302	1,708	31.2%
OpEx (US\$M)	1,011	1,220	20.7%
Operating Income (US\$M)	291	488	67.7%
Operating Margin	10.9%	13.6%	2.8 pp

Key finding: Q2 2026 revenue grew 34% YoY while operating income grew 68%. Operating margin improved from 10.9% to 13.6%, while OpEx grew 20.7% and fell from 37.7% to 34.0% of revenue. This is an example of operating leverage.

Sources: Shopify Q1/Q2 2026 and Q2/Q3 2025 published financial results; Shopify 2025 annual filing; SEC Company Facts API for the refreshable architecture.